Proposal: mandate and modalities for the future work of the GGE on LAWS

Decision 1

1. The Seventh Review Conference decides that the work of the open-ended Group of Governmental Experts related to emerging technologies in the area of lethal autonomous weapon systems established by Decision 1 of the Fifth Review Conference as contained in document CCW/CONF.V/10, adhering to the agreed recommendations contained in document CCW/CONF.V/2, is to continue, to strengthen the Convention.

2. In the context of the objectives and purpose of the Convention, the Group is to negotiate a new Protocol to the Convention, to address emerging technologies in the area of lethal autonomous weapon systems, building upon the set of elements of an instrument and other possible measures adopted by the Group in 2026 , and taking into account the example of existing Protocols within the Convention and previous recommendations and conclusions of the Group, and bringing in expertise on legal, military, and technological aspects.

3. International law, in particular the United Nations Charter and international humanitarian law, as well as relevant ethical perspectives should guide the continued work of the Group.

4. The rules of procedure of the Review Conference shall apply mutatis mutandis to the Group.

5. The Group shall conduct its work and adopt its report by consensus and shall submit a report containing the draft Protocol to the 2028 Meeting of High Contracting Parties. The Chair of the Group will update the 2027 Meeting of the High Contracting Parties on the work of the Group. The Group shall meet for 15 days in Geneva each year. Within these days, dedicated meetings of legal, military or technical experts may be convened to address specific legal and technical issues identified by the Chair as requiring further consideration, to facilitate the work of the Group.

6. The widest possible participation of all High Contracting Parties is to be promoted in accordance with the goals of the CCW Sponsorship Programme.

7. The GGE Chair will be designated by consensus through a written silence procedure.